Studli

Studli is a mobile app that connects students with study partners for focused study sessions, featuring a shared timer, personalized goals, and progress tracking to build productive study habits.

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Task: User Research and Persona Development

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1. Product Idea

Studli is a mobile application designed to help students stay motivated and focused by connecting them with study partners for short, flexible study sessions. The app features a shared focus timer, personalized session goals, and a simple progress tracker to encourage consistency, accountability, and productive study habits.

1.1 Problem Statement

Students commonly lose motivation and focus when studying alone. Existing study apps often charge subscriptions, feel confusing, limit what users can do, and need constant internet. Students also study in short gaps between classes, work and travel, which most tools do not support well.

1.2 Planned core features (to be validated)

- **Study Partner Matching:** Connect students with compatible partners for short study sessions.
- **Shared Focus Timer:** Help partners stay focused during study sessions.
- **Flexible Study Sessions:** Support sessions of different lengths to fit students' schedules.
- **Simple User Interface:** Provide a clean, easy-to-navigate experience.
- **Study Goals:** Allow users to set achievable goals for each session.
- **Progress Tracking:** Help users monitor their study consistency over time.

1.3 Target users

School and college students, and working learners, who study in India and need a low-cost, phone-friendly way to stay on track.

2. Methodology

Secondary research was conducted using publicly available studies and articles to understand students' study habits, challenges, and needs. The findings will guide the creation of three user personas for Studli.

2.1 Sources Used

1. Online Articles: Articles about student study habits, motivation, concentration, and time management.
2. Reddit: Public discussions about students' study challenges and experiences.
3. Quora: Questions and answers about study routines, productivity, and motivation.
4. App Store Reviews: User feedback on study planner, focus timer, and study-related apps.

2.2 Steps Followed

1. Explored online articles, Reddit and Quora discussions, and app reviews related to student's study habits.
2. Identified common challenges, including distractions, low motivation, and burnout.
3. Grouped similar observations into key themes.
4. Identified potential user groups based on shared needs and behaviours.
5. Developed three preliminary user personas based on the research findings.

2.3 Limitations

- No direct user surveys or interviews were conducted.
- Research relied on publicly available articles, social media discussions, and app reviews.
- Online opinions may not represent all students' experiences.
- Some findings may be subjective or biased.
- Identified user needs require further validation through real user research.

3. Research Findings

3.1 Key Findings

1. Loss of motivation while studying.
2. Difficulty maintaining focus.
3. Stress and burnout due to deadlines.
4. Some students benefit from external encouragement.
5. Messy notes and cramming can make revision difficult.

3.2 Research Sources and Theme Analysis

S. No.	Source Reviewed	Key Observation	Theme Identified
1.	Reddit discussion about studying consistently	Students may struggle to stay motivated to study regularly.	Loss of motivation
2.	Quora discussion about study challenges	Interest in studying may decrease over time.	Loss of motivation
3.	Quora discussion about online learning	Rushing assignments can contribute to stress.	Burnout and stress
4.	Reddit discussion about study pressure	Time pressure can make studying feel overwhelming.	Stress and deadlines
5.	Article about student study habits	Students may study in short sessions between daily activities.	Short study sessions
6.	Study app reviews	Distractions can interrupt focused study time.	Difficulty focusing
7.	Study app reviews	Some users dislike expensive subscriptions.	Affordability

8.	Study app reviews	Complicated features can make apps harder to use.	Ease of use
9.	Study app reviews	Users may want more flexible task-management options.	Flexible planning
10.	Reddit discussion	Study partners may provide encouragement and accountability.	Peer support

3.3 Behavior Findings

Question	Finding
When	Short study sessions between classes and longer sessions near exams
Where	Home or dorm (easy to get distracted), library (more focus), classrooms (follow lectures).
Device	Laptop for serious work, phone for quick review, tablet for some reading and notes.

3.4 Problems with Existing Apps

Complaint	Possible Design Implications
Subscription charges	Keep core features free
Poor customer service	Built-in help and feedback option
Confusing features	Simple, uncluttered interface
Limited tasks	Flexible, unrestricted task lists
Internet requirement	Offline mode for timers and tasks

3.5 Key Insights

- **Lack of motivation:** Students may struggle to maintain consistent study habits.
- **Difficulty focusing:** Distractions can interrupt concentration.
- **Academic stress:** Deadlines and last-minute preparation may increase pressure.
- **Need for accountability:** Some students may benefit from studying with a partner.
- **App usability:** Simple, affordable, and easy-to-use study tools may be preferable.

4. User Persona Development

Persona 1: Aarav Mehta

The School Student Who Needs a Push



Age: 16

Role: Class 12, student preparing for board exams

Location: Pune, India

Tech skill: Medium (phone-first)

Bio: Aarav was a good student, but now struggles to study alone at home. He pays attention in tuition classes where a teacher pushes him, but at home he loses focus after 30 to 40 minutes and feels slow and frustrated.

Goals & Motivations

- Build a routine so he can study at home without a tutor
- Finish tuition homework and still have time for other subjects
- Feel confident before board exams

Pain Points & Challenges

- Loses focus after 30 to 40 minutes
- Cannot convince himself to start studying
- Feels guilty and tired of himself when he falls behind
- Free apps often hide features behind subscriptions he cannot pay for

Behaviors

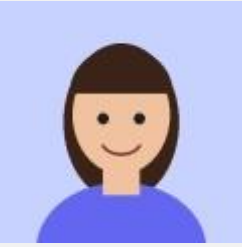
- Studies at home in the evening after tuition
- Focuses better when someone is guiding or watching
- Uses his phone for videos and messages

Tools & Tech

- Android phone, shared family laptop
- YouTube lessons, WhatsApp class groups
- Needs a free or low-cost tool

Persona 2: Ananya Tiwari

The First-Year Student Whose Motivation Fades



Age: 19

Role: First-year college student

Location: Hostel, Hyderabad, India

Tech skill: High

Bio: Ananya started the semester full of energy. A few weeks in, a hard assignment and a lower grade than she expected made her motivation drop. She either rushes work early and burns out, or delays it and panics. She often studies in her hostel room, where distractions are easy.

Goals & Motivations

- Stay motivated across the whole semester
- Spread her work out instead of rushing
- Study with people who keep her accountable

Pain Points & Challenges

- Motivation drops after weeks or after a bad grade
- Burnout from rushing early, then feeling less motivated
- Hostel room is distracting
- Features in study apps feel confusing

Behaviors

- Studies in her hostel room and sometimes the library
- Starts strong, then loses momentum
- Checks her phone often while studying

Tools & Tech

- Smartphone and laptop
- Notes app, Instagram, WhatsApp
- Tries new apps but quits when they feel complicated

Persona 3: Rahul Verma

The Commuter Using Tiny Time Slots



Age: 25

Role: Working professional studying part-time

Location: Lucknow, India

Tech skill: Medium

Bio: Rahul works full-time and is completing a degree part-time. He studies in short gaps: on his commute, during lunch, and between tasks. He mostly reviews on his phone and does deeper work on a laptop at night when he has the energy. Poor network on the road makes online-only apps frustrating.

Goals & Motivations

- Make use of spare minutes for quick review
- Plan study around a busy work schedule
- Keep everything in one simple app

Pain Points & Challenges

- Apps that need constant internet fail on his commute
- Limited task options do not fit his flexible routine
- Too many separate apps for notes, timers and tasks
- Little energy left for long evening sessions

Behaviors

- Reviews on his phone in short bursts
- Does deeper work on a laptop at night
- Heavier studying close to deadlines

Tools & Tech

- Smartphone, laptop
- Notes app, calendar, YouTube
- Prefers simple, fast tools

5. Research Findings and Design Implications

Finding	Personas	Design implication
Loss of motivation	Aarav, Ananya	Study partner, shared goals and progress view
Difficulty focusing	Aarav	Short 25 to 40 minute sessions, optional focus mode
Burnout and stress	Ananya	Spread study across days, gentle reminders, no pressure streaks
Need for outside push	Aarav	Live partner sessions for accountability
Short time slots and phone-first use	Rahul	Quick-start sessions, mobile-first design
App complaints: cost, confusion, limited tasks, internet	Aarav, Ananya, Rahul	Free core, simple UI, flexible tasks, offline mode
Messy notes and cramming	Ananya	Simple prioritization view and revision reminders

User-Centered Design Principles Applied

- **Research-based design:** Each proposed feature is linked to an observation from the sources reviewed.
- **Diverse personas:** The personas represent different ages, goals, schedules, and levels of technology comfort.
- **User-focused language:** Pain points are described in simple, relatable language to reflect users' potential experiences.
- **Usability and simplicity:** Proposed features aim to make studying easier without adding unnecessary complexity.
- **Future validation:** The next step is to create a prototype and test it with real users to validate the personas and design assumptions.

6. Conclusion

This project explored student's study challenges through online articles, public discussions, and app reviews. The findings helped identify common themes, including low motivation, difficulty focusing, and study-related stress. Three fictional user personas were developed to represent different learner needs and guide Studli's proposed features.

7. References

- **Reddit:**

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- **App review:**

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